

Mark Smalley

Chief Technology Officer · Blockchain Protocol Architect · Engineering Leader

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BNY

Re: Director, Product and Innovation — Tokenisation

I have spent 15 years building production blockchain infrastructure for institutional clients, from the first bank-backed blockchain hackathon at DBS Bank Singapore to regulatory sandbox admission by the Securities Commission Malaysia. Your Director of Tokenisation role sits precisely at the intersection where I have operated throughout my career: translating complex blockchain protocols into secure, compliant payment and custody products for institutional and corporate clients.

Specific evidence mapped to your requirements:

- ▶ **Digital asset & tokenisation experience:** Sole developer of the Ordzaar prototype (Bitcoin Ordinals marketplace) at CakeDefi, which spun out, raised US\$500K, and was acquired. Co-authored the SADO Protocol, a self-authenticating order-book standard for tokenised Bitcoin assets. Co-founded CoKeeps, now Malaysia's largest Digital Asset Custodian by AUM.
- ▶ **Payment systems & blockchain protocols:** Deep protocol-level expertise across both UTXO (Bitcoin scripting, Schnorr/Taproot, Ordinals) and EVM (Solidity, ERC-20/721, DeFi). Built SDK infrastructure that processed 1M+ API requests at the DBS Bank hackathon. Authored the Everstore protocol (relational database on BIP32 key derivation) and DN-Key protocol for decentralised key management.
- ▶ **Regulatory awareness (AML/KYC, digital assets):** First company admitted to the Securities Commission Malaysia regulatory sandbox. Contributed directly to Malaysia's national Digital Asset regulatory roadmap alongside the central bank. Built production KYC/AML pipeline systems. Neuroware ranked in Deloitte's Top 50 Global RegTech.
- ▶ **Product strategy & commercialisation:** Led the technical pivot at Oviato from consumer app to B2B infrastructure provider, securing DraperVC investment. At CakeDefi (170-engineer company), grew the Moonshot team from 1 to 10, defining product vision and stakeholder reporting for what became the company's fifth business vertical.
- ▶ **Stakeholder management & client engagement:** Enterprise clients include DBS Bank (Singapore) and Baker Hostetler (US law firm, 5-day intensive engagement). TEDx speaker on financial inclusion. Regular presenter at fintech conferences. Experienced bridging technical depth with commercial outcomes across regulators, investors, and institutional clients.

What distinguishes my background for this role is that I have operated on both sides of the institutional divide. I understand permissioned chains and regulatory constraints from building inside them (Securities Commission sandbox, CoKeeps custody), while my open-source protocol work (SADO, Ordit SDK, Everstore) demonstrates the public chain fluency needed to evaluate stablecoin settlement, deposit tokens, and cross-border rail architectures. I have shipped products that required interoperability between traditional financial infrastructure and blockchain, not merely theorised about them.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my experience building institutional-grade blockchain products, navigating regulatory frameworks, and leading engineering teams from prototype to production could contribute to BNY's tokenisation strategy. I am based in the UK and available to meet in London at your convenience.

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